

Hydrostor

Long-Duration Energy Storage · Advanced Compressed-Air Storage Developer & Operator · Toronto (US HQ Denver, Colorado) · Private (\$230M equity, Aug 2026; valuation not stated)

Hydrostor, the Toronto developer of cavern-scale compressed-air storage backed by Goldman Sachs, CPP Investments and Canada Growth Fund, closed a \$230M equity investment on 12 August to carry its 500 MW Willow Rock plant in California to financial close this year and its Australian Silver City project into construction.

70

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Andretti Formula E

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

On 12 August Hydrostor closed a \$230M equity investment: the conversion of the note committed by Canada Growth Fund, Goldman Sachs Alternatives and CPP Investments in February 2025, plus a strategic round from Baker Hughes, Realize Capital Partners and Hatch. The new-money share is not broken out. It follows US\$55M from Export Development Canada in September 2025 and Baker Hughes' January agreement pairing equity with up to 1.4 GW of equipment orders. The money has a stated job: a 7 GW pipeline and Willow Rock, 500 MW in Kern County, to financial close this year.

This is the half-year in which a developer becomes a builder. Willow Rock holds a California licence granted on 19 December 2025 and a 25-year offtake with Central Coast Community Energy worth about \$1B; Silver City in Broken Hill won grid-connection approval on 2 September and is due to start construction. Goderich in Ontario has run commercially since 2020. A company about to pour concrete in two countries needs a public identity it lacks.

WHY NOW

Financial close on Willow Rock and first construction at Silver City both fall in the fourth quarter, the window in which Formula E teams finalise Season 13 rosters before the Jeddah opener on 18 December. Austin follows on 6 February and Miami on 20 February 2027.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$230M

\$230M equity investment closed 12 Aug 2026, which includes the conversion of the previously announced note...

\$55M

Canada Growth Fund, Goldman Sachs Alternatives, CPP Investments; strategic investors Baker Hughes (investor...

\$1B

Willow Rock holds a California licence granted on 19 December 2025 and a 25-year offtake with Central Coast...

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE FE GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 10 OF 35 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Andretti Formula E	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Envision Racing	TAKEN	Teijin
Lola Yamaha ABT Formula E Team	TAKEN	Shell
Citroën Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A well-backed storage developer at the moment its first two utility-scale plants go to financial close and construction, with no brand, no CMO and no rival storage name on the Andretti roster. Partner-level, halo-honest, timed to the Season 13 launch and two US rounds in February.

FUNDING EVENT

CATEGORY WHITESPACE

CONSTRUCTION MILESTONE

DISCOVERY: SCAN

WHY ANDRETTI FORMULA E

Andretti's roster is TWG AI as primary partner, Quest Global, Crowe UK and Reflo, with Nissan power from Season 13; there is no energy, storage, utility or grid brand on it. It is the American team for a company headquartered in Denver for the US with its first US plant in California; Austin and Miami arrive within weeks of Willow Rock's financial close. Envision Racing, the obvious energy fit, is titled by a rival grid-battery maker.

VALUE TO ANDRETTI FORMULA E — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B - halo, honestly stated: a cavern-scale storage developer has no workstream on a race car. The mechanics are commercial. Formula E sells itself as the championship of electrification; a partner that stores electricity for eight hours gives Andretti an energy story its roster lacks. Hydrostor brings utilities, community-choice buyers, regulators and project financiers to Austin and Miami, and a technology narrative for the team's content.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Energy Storage Partner. **THREE YEARS**, Seasons 13-15, spanning Willow Rock construction and the first Silver City operations. Estimated \$1-2M a season at partner level. Scope: car and suit placement, Austin and Miami hospitality, co-produced content on long-duration storage, and a Willow Rock site activation.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Curtis VanWalleghem

CO-FOUNDER & CEO, HYDROSTOR · **VERIFIED**

VanWalleghem launched Hydrostor in 2010 and fronts every raise, so a first brand partnership is his call. Path: Jon Norman, President; Jordan Cole, Chief Commercial Officer, ex-Brookfield; Beth Summers, Chief Financial Officer. No chief marketing officer is listed, which is itself the opening.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the construction moment.

“Curtis, Willow Rock closes and Silver City breaks ground in the same quarter Formula E launches Season 13; Andretti is the American team with an open energy lane and Austin and Miami in February. 25 minutes before Jeddah to see whether the timing works?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 16 / 20 Round closed 12 Aug; Jeddah 18 Dec, Austin and Miami in Feb.	CAPACITY 13 / 20 \$230M includes a note conversion; capital is for projects.	BRAND FIT 14 / 20 Storage is FE's message, but the audience is B2B.	URGENCY 14 / 20 Financial close and first construction both in Q4 2026.	OPS FIT 13 / 20 MODE B: no car workstream; open lane at Andretti.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

PROJECT MONEY, NOT BRAND MONEY The \$230M includes converted notes and is earmarked for a 7 GW pipeline; no valuation or marketing budget is stated and there is no CMO. **Counter:** Size at partner level, hospitality weighted to Austin and Miami; ask for the budget line on the first call.

A HALO WITH NO WORKSTREAM Compressed-air caverns have nothing to do on a race car; the deal rests on story and audience. **Counter:** Anchor on Formula E's electrification message and a Willow Rock site activation; do not overclaim integration.

SOURCES — 13 OF 13 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

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